

Verified

UEFA European Championship

The European Championship began in 1960 as the European Nations' Cup. Early final tournaments had only four teams. The modern EURO expanded to eight teams in 1980, sixteen in 1996, and twenty-four in 2016.

UEFA European Championship editions, 1960 onward

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
<u>2024</u>	Germany	24	<u>Spain</u>	England	France	Netherlands	Spain 2-1 England

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
<u>2020</u>	Eleven European cities	24	<u>Italy</u>	England	Spain	Denmark	1-1; Italy pens
<u>2016</u>	France	24	<u>Portugal</u>	France	Germany	Wales	Portugal 1 France (a

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
<u>2012</u>	Poland and Ukraine	16	<u>Spain</u>	Italy	Germany	Portugal	Spain 4-0
<u>2008</u>	Austria and Switzerland	16	<u>Spain</u>	Germany	Russia	Türkiye	Spain 1-0 Germany

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
<u>2004</u>	Portugal	16	<u>Greece</u>	Portugal	Czech Republic	Netherlands	Greece 1- Portugal
<u>2000</u>	Belgium and Netherlands	16	<u>France</u>	Italy	Portugal	Netherlands	France 2- Italy (gold goal)
<u>1996</u>	England	16	<u>Germany</u>	Czech Republic	England	France	Germany Czech Rep (golden go

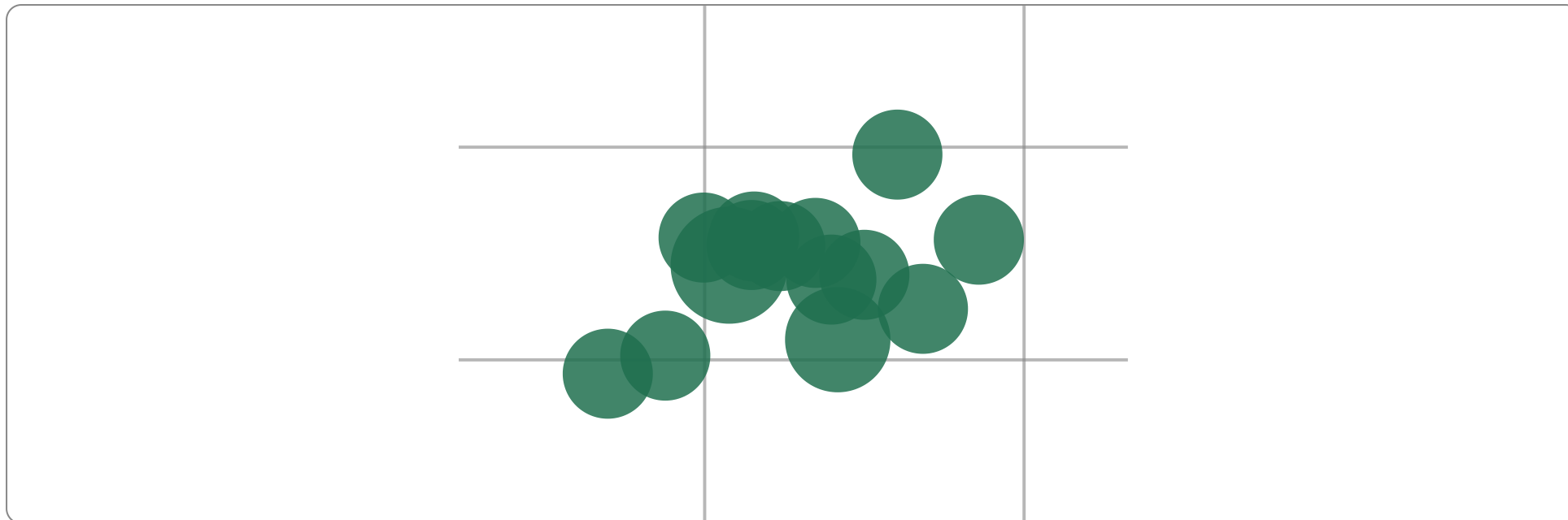
Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
<u>1992</u>	Sweden	8	<u>Denmark</u>	Germany	Netherlands	Sweden	Denmark 1-0 Germany
<u>1988</u>	West Germany	8	<u>Netherlands</u>	Soviet Union	West Germany	Italy	Netherlands 2-0 Soviet Union
<u>1984</u>	France	8	<u>France</u>	Spain	Portugal	Denmark	France 2-0 Spain
<u>1980</u>	Italy	8	<u>West Germany</u>	Belgium	Czechoslovakia	Italy	West Germany 2-1 Belgium

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
<u>1976</u>	Yugoslavia	4	<u>Czechoslovakia</u>	West Germany	Netherlands	Yugoslavia	2-2; Czechoslo 5-3 pens
<u>1972</u>	Belgium	4	<u>West Germany</u>	Soviet Union	Belgium	Hungary	West Gern 3-0 Soviet Union
<u>1968</u>	Italy	4	<u>Italy</u>	Yugoslavia	England	Soviet Union	Italy 2-0 Yugoslavia (replay)
<u>1964</u>	Spain	4	<u>Spain</u>	Soviet Union	Hungary	Denmark	Spain 2-1 Soviet Uni

France  1984, 2000	2
Soviet Union  1960	1
Czechoslovakia  1976	1
Netherlands  1988	1
Denmark  1992	1
Greece  2004	1
Portugal  2016	1

Where the tournament has been hosted

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



Europe

France 3 times

1960, 1984, 2016

Spain 1 time

1964

Italy 2 times

1968, 1980

Belgium 1 time

1972

Yugoslavia 1 time

1976

West Germany 1 time

1988

Sweden 1 time

1992

England 1 time

1996

Belgium and Netherlands 1

time

2000

Portugal 1 time

2004

Austria and Switzerland 1

time

2008

Poland and Ukraine 1 time

2012

Eleven European cities 1

time

2020

Germany 1 time

2024

How it works

- UEFA national teams qualify over roughly two years of group matches before the finals.
- The finals open with a group stage; the best-placed teams in each group move on.
- From the quarterfinals onward it is a straight knockout: a single loss ends a team's tournament.
- The final decides the champion; no third-place match has been played since 1980 (see "Historical format note" below).

Historical format note

A third-place match was played through 1980. From 1984 onward, UEFA recognizes both defeated semifinalists without ranking them third and fourth. The table therefore uses neutral “other semifinalist” wording.

Player of the Tournament winners

- UEFA has named a best-player award at every EURO since 1996; no equivalent award existed at the four earlier editions.
- **1996:** Matthias Sammer (Germany).
- **2000:** Zinedine Zidane (France).
- **2004:** Theodoros Zagorakis (Greece) - captain of the surprise 2004 champions.
- **2008:** Xavi Hernández (Spain).
- **2012:** Andrés Iniesta (Spain).
- **2016:** Antoine Griezmann (France) - runner-up with France, the only winner of the award not to lift the trophy that year.
- **2020:** Gianluigi Donnarumma (Italy) - the first goalkeeper to win the award.
- **2024:** Rodri (Spain).

Young Player of the Tournament winners

- UEFA has named a best-player-aged-21-or-under award at every EURO since 2016; no equivalent award existed at earlier editions.
- **2016:** Renato Sanches (Portugal).
- **2020:** Pedri (Spain).
- **2024:** Lamine Yamal (Spain).

Memorable moments

- Antonín Panenka's famous chipped penalty decided the 1976 shoot-out.
- Denmark entered the 1992 tournament late and went on to win it.
- Greece produced one of international football's greatest surprises in 2004.
- Spain became the first nation to retain the EURO title in 2012.

- The delayed EURO 2020 was played in 2021 across multiple countries.
- Spain won a record fourth title in 2024.

References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 30 August 2026

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.